INFORMATION TO KEEP WITH YOU

My complete treatment handbook

Aflibercept + FOLFIRI

Understand your treatment. Know what to expect. Keep your plan to hand.

Displayed calendar
14 days
See the active treatment phase

Treatment stages
1
Explained in the treatment reference

Regimen source
NCCP 00238
Version 6

> Day 1: aflibercept, then irinotecan, folinic acid and fluorouracil, followed by a 46-hour fluorouracil pump. Repeat every 14 days while beneficial and tolerable.

Treatment stages

01 **14-day treatment cycle**
Day ward → home pump → review

Your team confirms the active stage and dates. The full treatment guide explains each step.

Inside your handbook

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My name _____

Hospital / oncology team _____

Use the urgent instructions and contact numbers in your treatment guide. Your team must replace example numbers before patient use. Your individual treatment plan takes precedence.

CHAPTER 01

Understanding your treatment

IN THIS CHAPTER

Why this treatment is offered, what its medicines do, and how the agreed plan fits your care.

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Fever, shivers or sudden illness needs immediate oncology advice. Chest pain, collapse or severe breathing difficulty needs emergency help. Call urgently for severe or persistent diarrhoea, severe abdominal pain, inability to drink, reduced urine or a line/pump problem. Major bleeding, a painful swollen limb, sudden weakness, a severe headache or visual change also needs urgent assessment.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

Your medicines and what they do

Aflibercept with FOLFIRI is used for metastatic colorectal cancer that is resistant to, or has progressed after, an oxaliplatin-containing treatment. The aim is to control the cancer and symptoms; treatment continues while its benefit outweighs its side effects.

ANTI-ANGIOGENIC FUSION PROTEIN

Aflibercept

Zaltrap



Traps blood-vessel growth signals

Aflibercept acts as a decoy receptor. It binds VEGF-A, VEGF-B and placental growth factor (PlGF), reducing signals that help new blood vessels support a tumour. Normal blood vessels and wound healing can also be affected.

VEGF / PlGF signals → Aflibercept traps the signals → New-vessel growth is reduced

What to watch for

Report significant bleeding, a painful swollen limb, severe abdominal pain, a severe headache or a wound that is not healing. Tell oncology before any planned operation or dental procedure.

TOPOISOMERASE I CHEMOTHERAPY

Irinotecan

Campto



Interrupts deoxyribonucleic acid (the cell's genetic material) (DNA) copying

The body converts irinotecan into SN-38. This traps an enzyme called topoisomerase I while DNA is being copied, causing damage that can stop cancer cells dividing. Normal bowel and blood-forming cells can also be affected.

Irinotecan becomes SN-38 → DNA-repair enzyme is trapped → Dividing cells are damaged

What to watch for

Tell the nurse immediately about cramps, sweating or diarrhoea during the infusion. Diarrhoea starting later needs the separate written treatment and contact plan.

CHEMOTHERAPY MODULATOR

Folinic acid

Calcium leucovorin



Strengthens fluorouracil action

Folinic acid helps fluorouracil remain bound to an enzyme needed to make DNA. In this regimen it increases fluorouracil activity and can also increase its unwanted effects. It is not a vitamin supplement to start yourself.

Folinic acid → Stronger enzyme binding → Fluorouracil effect increases

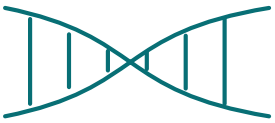
What to watch for

The combined treatment can increase mouth soreness and diarrhoea. Report these promptly. Rare allergic reactions can occur.

CHEMOTHERAPY

Fluorouracil

5-FU



Disrupts cell building blocks

Fluorouracil interferes with the production and use of DNA and RNA, the instructions cells need to grow. The infusion extends exposure over approximately two days.

Drug enters cell → DNA / RNA disrupted → Growth slows

What to watch for

Diarrhoea, mouth sores and skin soreness may become serious. Chest pain during the pump infusion needs emergency assessment. Unexpected severe early toxicity can occur even after dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) testing.

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

Your treatment aim and evidence

The setting and sequence matter.

What studies can tell us

VELOUR studied people with metastatic colorectal cancer previously treated with oxaliplatin. Adding aflibercept to FOLFIRI improved tumour response, delayed progression and produced a modest average survival improvement compared with FOLFIRI alone. Side effects were more frequent. The results describe groups, not an individual extra lifespan, and do not establish benefit in a different treatment line.

Review and your priorities

Ask when benefit will be reviewed and which symptoms, scans or tests will be used. Discuss work, caring responsibilities, time at home and what matters most to you. Delaying or reducing a medicine can be necessary for safety and does not itself prove treatment has failed.

Understanding the evidence

Ask which study population and treatment sequence match your plan.

CHAPTER 02

Your schedule, tests and appointments

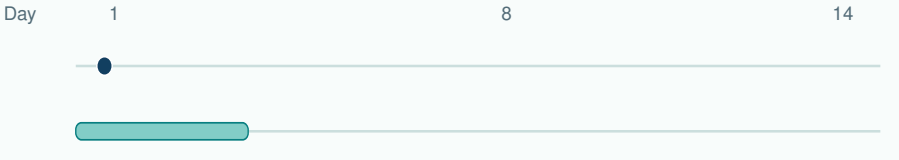
IN THIS CHAPTER

Your treatment stages, checks and practical preparations, from before treatment through follow-up.

Your treatment plan

Aflibercept + FOLFIRI

14-day view



This shows treatment timing, not guaranteed symptom-free days. Your team confirms the active phase and dates.

DAY WARD → HOME PUMP → REVIEW

14-day treatment cycle

D1 D2 D3 D14

Day 1: aflibercept, then irinotecan, folinic acid and fluorouracil, followed by a 46-hour fluorouracil pump. Repeat every 14 days while beneficial and tolerable.

There is no fixed number of cycles for every patient. The team reviews benefit, side effects and your priorities; a break, maintenance approach or drug change needs an individual decision.

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Required and conditional checks across your treatment

Required checks are shown explicitly. electrocardiogram (ECG), additional urine tests and anticoagulant tests apply only when indicated. Scans and tumour markers follow your individual cancer plan; this page does not prescribe a universal surveillance interval. Confirm who books and reviews each test.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00238 v6 · official regimen

Tests in your plan

Carcinoembryonic antigen (CEA) — colorectal plans

If part of your plan

WHEN

For a colorectal cancer plan, if your team uses CEA; your team sets the interval.

A marker trend interpreted alongside symptoms, examination and scans.

Record the baseline, latest result and next date. A marker change alone does not establish progression.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Aflibercept + FOLFIRI: treatment and checks

Metastatic colorectal cancer

Day 1: aflibercept, then irinotecan, folinic acid and fluorouracil, followed by a 46-hour fluorouracil pump. Repeat every 14 days while beneficial and tolerable.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	During treatment	Between visits	Review / change	After treatment
Blood counts / kidneys / liver NCCP 00238	Required baseline blood count, kidney and liver tests	Required before each cycle; results reviewed before treatment	Earlier tests if unwell, dehydrated or toxicity develops	Recovery and results guide delay or dose adjustment	Follow unresolved abnormalities as agreed
DPD / fluoropyrimidine safety NCCP 00238	DPD test before fluorouracil or capecitabine unless already tested	The result guides the starting plan; it does not exclude all severe toxicity	Unexpected severe early mouth sores, diarrhoea or illness needs urgent assessment	The team reviews suspected severe reactions before further treatment	Keep the result and any toxicity history in your records
Blood pressure / urine / healing NCCP 00238	Required baseline blood pressure (BP) and urine protein	Urine dipstick each cycle; blood pressure monitored during treatment	Report severe headache, bleeding, swelling, reduced urine or poor healing	A raised urine protein/ creatinine ratio may require a 24-hour collection; team interprets results	Aflibercept must be held at least four weeks before elective surgery; oncology directs timing
Heart assessment NCCP 00238	Review cardiac history; baseline ECG if cardiac function is compromised	Report any new chest pain or breathing change	Chest pain, collapse or severe breathing difficulty needs emergency assessment	Additional heart tests only when clinically indicated	Follow any identified heart problem; no fixed routine echo series

Care / check	Before starting	During treatment	Between visits	Review / change	After treatment
international normalised ratio (blood-clotting test) (INR) only if taking warfarin NCCP 00238	Tell the team about warfarin; arrange INR monitoring	INR as clinically indicated, rather than a universal weekly schedule	Report bleeding, bruising or significant changes in intake	The prescribing team adjusts warfarin if needed	Continue the individually agreed anticoagulation follow-up
Response / scans / tumour markers NCCP 00238	Agree a baseline disease assessment and treatment aim	Review symptoms, function and clinical benefit	New symptoms may require earlier review	Scans and tumour markers follow the consultant-directed cancer plan	Agree next treatment or follow-up; there is no universal scan interval in this regimen

What each check is for

1 **14-day treatment cycle**

Day ward → home pump → review

Aflibercept with FOLFIRI is used for metastatic colorectal cancer that is resistant to, or has progressed after, an oxaliplatin-containing treatment. The aim is to control the cancer and symptoms; treatment continues while its benefit outweighs its side effects.

Ask / act: Confirm the phase, prescription, tests and supportive medicines before starting.

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Your port and treatment pump

From preparing the line to coming home after disconnection. Your team arranges the appointments and shows you what to do.

1 · Before treatment

Choose and prepare the line

The team explains whether a port or peripherally inserted central catheter (PICC) suits your treatment. You receive instructions for the insertion appointment.

2 · Insertion and recovery

A separate appointment may be needed

For a port, numbing medicine is used and a small device is placed under the skin. Ask about sedation, transport and wound care.

3 · Day 1

The nurse connects your pump

After the day-ward medicines, the nurse checks and connects the fluorouracil pump. Ask for a demonstration before leaving.

4 · At home

Treatment continues for about 46 hours

Carry the pump as shown. Keep the dressing dry and protect the line from pulling, heat and damage.

5 · As arranged

Return for disconnection

A trained professional checks the infusion, disconnects the pump and cares for the line. The appointment is based on connection time.

6 · Between cycles

The access device usually stays

A port needle can be removed while the port stays under the skin. A PICC remains in the arm with ongoing dressing and line care.

Port or PICC: what is the difference?

A port is a small chamber beneath the skin, usually on the chest, attached to a tube ending in a large vein. A special needle goes through the skin into the port when it is used. A PICC enters a vein in the upper arm; a short section remains outside under a dressing. Both can deliver a home infusion. Your team helps choose the device and teaches its care.

Before insertion and during recovery

Tell the team about allergies, blood thinners, infections and any other cancer medicines. Follow the instructions about eating, drinking and transport; do not stop medicines yourself. Port placement uses local anaesthetic, sometimes with sedation or general anaesthetic. The team explains the procedure and risks, including infection, bleeding, clots and insertion complications. Ask how to manage discomfort, protect the wound and resume activity. Report increasing pain, redness, swelling, discharge or fever.

Connection: what the nurse does

The nurse checks the line and treatment, secures the connection and dressing, and starts the pump. Before leaving, you should have the disconnection location and time, contact numbers including out of hours, and the written spill instructions. Ask to be shown what normal pump progress looks like. You do not need to calculate a rate.

Carrying it, sleeping and washing

Use the supplied carrier and the position recommended for your pump. Keep tubing free from pulling and kinks. Ask how to place the pump safely for sleep and how to protect the line and dressing when washing. Do not immerse it or swim. Avoid direct heat and cold. An elastomeric pump has a balloon that shrinks slowly and may have no alarm; an electronic pump has different instructions. Follow the instructions for the device you actually receive.

Disconnection is not port removal

Keep the appointment even if the pump looks empty, unless the team changes the plan. Staff check the pump and line and arrange safe disposal. After flushing and other line care as required, the port needle may be removed and a small dressing applied. The implanted port stays in place until a separate removal procedure is arranged. A PICC remains in place and needs scheduled dressing and flushing care.

Leakage, disconnection or unexpected pump progress

Call the team immediately if the pump leaks, is damaged, finishes unexpectedly early, appears not to run, or the line disconnects. Follow the emergency or spill steps you have been specifically taught, including use of a clamp if instructed. Do not reconnect, change settings or disconnect the pump yourself. Keep other people away from leaked medicine. If medicine touches skin, rinse it off and wash with soap and water, then seek advice.

Pain, swelling or feeling unwell

Contact oncology immediately for pain or swelling around the line, a wet/loose dressing, redness, fever, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell. A painful swollen arm or neck needs urgent advice. Severe chest pain, major breathing difficulty or collapse: call 112 / 999. Do not wait for pump disconnection or the next clinic visit.

The drawings show general steps, not instructions for inserting or accessing a line. Your hospital confirms its own arrangements and the care instructions for your device.

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before starting

Confirm the aim, DPD result, test appointments, prescribed supportive medicines and working urgent contact numbers. Bring your full medicines list, including supplements.

STEP 2

Line, pump and disconnection

Agree the access device and care training. The pump runs for 46 hours; confirm the disconnection appointment from its connection time. Do not alter settings, disconnect or reconnect it unless specifically trained and instructed.

STEP 3

If the plan changes

The team confirms the next treatment, blood-test and supportive-medicine dates after a delay or dose change. Do not use a previous calendar as a prescription.

STEP 4

Contacts, paper copies and QR

The example telephone numbers on the wallet card are placeholders. Your team must replace them with working daytime and out-of-hours numbers before patient use. Keep the card with you; the QR opens the regimen information, not your confidential medical record.

Your treatment schedule

Use your prescription and team-confirmed calendar.

Medicines and sequence

Aflibercept 4 mg/kg is infused over 60 minutes before FOLFIRI. Irinotecan 180 mg/m² is given over 90 minutes and folinic acid 400 mg/m² over two hours (200 mg/m² may be considered). Fluorouracil 400 mg/m² is given as a bolus, followed by 2,400 mg/m² continuously over 46 hours. Your team confirms prescribed doses and the disconnection appointment.

How long treatment lasts

There is no fixed number of cycles for everyone. Treatment is reviewed against cancer control, side effects and your priorities. A change to maintenance or a break is an individual decision.

The disconnection appointment

The fluorouracil infusion lasts 46 hours from connection. Arrange the completion visit before leaving the unit. Pump removal does not remove an implanted port: the port remains until a separate procedure is arranged.

Before, during and after treatment

Testing detects problems that may not cause symptoms.

Before the first dose

Blood count, kidney and liver tests and DPD testing are required before fluoropyrimidine treatment unless the DPD test has already been done. DPD helps the body clear fluorouracil; deficiency changes the treatment plan. A normal result does not exclude all severe toxicity.

Before each cycle

Blood count, kidney and liver results and symptoms are reviewed before each cycle. Missing results are not assumed normal.

Heart tests are conditional

Tell the team about heart disease and previous chest symptoms. An ECG is needed when cardiac function is compromised or clinical findings warrant it. There is no automatic recurring echocardiogram schedule for every patient.



Scans, markers and aftercare

Your consultant decides response scans, tumour-marker use and follow-up according to your cancer and treatment aim. This regimen does not set one scan or marker interval for everyone. Unresolved side effects or abnormal blood results need a follow-up plan.

CHAPTER 03

Symptoms and supportive care

IN THIS CHAPTER

Recognising changes, knowing when to call, and using your prescribed supportive-care plan.

Day 1 → Day 14: a general pattern

This is a visual orientation, not a prediction of your personal cycle. It shows when some effects often emerge and which effects are **not** tied to a particular day.

Treatment or check	Timing in this view
Day-ward medicines	 **Day 1** intravenous (IV)
Fluorouracil pump	 **Days 1–3** 46 hours; disconnect as arranged
Early cramps / sweating	 **Day 1** Tell the nurse immediately
Delayed diarrhoea	 **Days 2–14** May start after 24 hours; follow written plan
Blood counts / infection	 **Days 1–14** No guaranteed safe days
Mouth / bowel / energy	 **Days 1–14** Timing varies; record and report symptoms
Blood pressure / bleeding / healing	 **Days 1–14** These effects are not confined to infusion day

Day ward and home pump: Day 1 infusions lead into a 46-hour pump. The disconnection visit is arranged from the actual connection time.

No safe window: Fever, sudden illness or a serious symptom needs action on any day, including after pump removal.

Treatment review: There is no fixed number of cycles for every patient. The team reviews benefit, side effects and your priorities; a break, maintenance approach or drug change needs an individual decision.

Two different bowel reactions: Cramps and sweating during infusion need immediate nursing attention. Diarrhoea starting more than 24 hours later needs the separate written home plan and early contact.

Between visits: Record symptoms and their effects on drinking, eating, bowel/stoma output, mobility and usual activities.

> **Why these bands stay broad:** Bars show planned treatment and possible symptom patterns, not measured risk. Side effects can overlap and persist. Band length does not show likelihood or severity, and the chart cannot tell you whether it is safe to receive treatment. NCCP 00238 v6 · official regimen ↗

> **There are no guaranteed "safe days".** Act on fever, sudden illness or a new serious symptom whenever it occurs. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Between-treatment notes

Day 1: Infusion and pump connection

The team checks symptoms, blood results and the active treatment plan. Day-ward infusions are followed by connection of the fluorouracil pump. Before leaving, confirm the pump-care instructions, disconnection appointment and contact number.

Day 2–3: The pump is delivering treatment

The pump runs for approximately 46 hours from connection. Keep the device and line secure and dry as taught. The team confirms the actual disconnection appointment. Call for a leaking, disconnected or unexpectedly stopped pump. Do not reconnect, alter settings or disconnect it yourself unless specifically trained and instructed.

Day 4–7: After disconnection

Delayed diarrhoea can begin after the first 24 hours and may continue after pump removal. Use your written plan and contact the team early. Nausea and tiredness can overlap; symptoms are not restricted to these days. Report poor intake, persistent diarrhoea or mouth pain early. Chest pain or major breathing difficulty requires emergency help.

Day 8–14: Between visits and the next review

Blood counts can fall between visits. Tell the team about bowel symptoms, mouth pain and how you are managing daily activities. Treatment proceeds only after review. Bring the symptom passport and check the next appointment. Day 1 usually repeats 14 days after this cycle started, only if confirmed.

Support around the medicines

1 Nausea prevention and rescue

Irinotecan has a moderate risk of sickness without prevention. Follow the prescribed prevention and rescue medicines. Call if vomiting prevents drinking; do not duplicate steroids or anti-sickness doses.

2

Blood counts and recovery

Growth-factor injections depend on your risk, blood counts and previous complications. If prescribed, confirm their timing in relation to chemotherapy and pump removal; do not assume everyone receives them.

3

Early and delayed diarrhoea plans

Atropine is normally prescribed before irinotecan for early cramps, sweating or diarrhoea. It is avoided with glaucoma; tell the team about asthma as well. At home use the separately prescribed delayed-diarrhoea instructions. This can differ from standard over-the-counter dosing. Keep the medicine and urgent-contact plan available.

Bowel symptoms and hydration

Act early; do not wait for the next appointment.

Keep the written plan

Record the change from your usual bowel pattern, including stoma output. Keep the prescribed diarrhoea medicine and your oncology contact details available. Ask for specific instructions before the first treatment.

Two different irinotecan reactions

During or soon after infusion, cramps, sweating, a runny nose or diarrhoea can be an early cholinergic reaction: tell the nurse immediately. Diarrhoea starting more than 24 hours later needs the separate prescribed delayed-diarrhoea plan, which may differ from packet instructions. If it persists despite that plan, or you become unwell, seek urgent advice.

Urgent symptoms

Contact oncology urgently for persistent diarrhoea, inability to drink, reduced urine, dizziness, blood in stools, fever or severe abdominal pain. Do not assume severe abdominal pain is an ordinary treatment effect. A stoma can make fluid loss less obvious: report a marked increase in output.

Blood vessels, urine and wound healing

This part of the plan relates to aflibercept.

Blood pressure and urine

Blood pressure and urine protein are checked before treatment and monitored during the course. Urine dipstick testing is required each cycle. Raised urine protein results can lead to a protein/creatinine ratio and a 24-hour collection; the team interprets these results.

Symptoms needing urgent assessment

Seek urgent help for major bleeding, a painful swollen limb, chest pain, sudden weakness, a severe headache with visual change, or severe abdominal pain. Rare serious problems include blood clots, bowel perforation or an abnormal connection called a fistula. Report any new wound or a wound that is not healing.

Operations, dental work and lines

Aflibercept must be suspended at least four weeks before elective surgery. Tell the oncology team before any operation, significant dental procedure or line insertion. The team coordinates treatment interruption and restart with healing; do not stop or restart it yourself.

If you take warfarin

Tell the team about all anticoagulants. For warfarin, INR is monitored as clinically indicated; this protocol does not impose the bevacizumab weekly schedule. Only change anticoagulants as instructed.

Mouth, skin, energy and infection

Frequency and urgency are different.

Mouth and hands or feet

Fluorouracil can cause mouth ulcers and painful redness or peeling of hands and feet. Report symptoms early, especially if eating, drinking, walking or using your hands becomes difficult. Ask for non-irritating mouth care and skin-care advice.

Nausea, appetite and fatigue

Use the anti-sickness prescription and call if it is not controlling symptoms. Small regular meals and manageable activity with rest may help daily routines. Fatigue can have several causes; persistent or worsening fatigue may need blood tests or review. Irinotecan may also cause hair thinning or loss; ask about practical support.

Low blood counts and infection

Chemotherapy can reduce white cells, red cells and platelets. Fever, shivers or sudden illness needs immediate oncology advice, even if your temperature is not raised. Follow the unit’s temperature instructions and do not wait for a scheduled blood test. Unusual bruising, bleeding, breathlessness or marked weakness also needs review.

Heart and infusion symptoms

Fluorouracil can rarely cause serious heart problems. Chest pain, collapse or severe breathing difficulty needs emergency assessment. Tell the nurse immediately if flushing, swelling, wheeze, rash or pain occurs during an infusion.

Your line and home pump

Ask for a demonstration and show the team what you would do.

Access and ordinary care

The team selects a port, PICC or other suitable access with you. Keep dressings and connections secure and follow the specific washing, bathing and activity instructions. Keep the pump away from excessive heat or cold.

Leak, disconnection or unexpected flow

Call the oncology contact for a leaking or disconnected pump, pain/swelling at the line, a pump that finishes early, or one that appears not to be delivering. Do not change settings or reconnect or disconnect the device unless specifically trained and instructed. Follow the spill/emergency steps the unit has taught you.

Disconnection and future care

The pump is disconnected at the arranged visit and the line is cared for. A port needle can be removed while the implanted port stays under the skin. Ask when any dressing changes, flushes or later line removal are due.

Supportive medicines and daily life

The prescription changes with the active treatment.

Your supportive prescription

Confirm prevention and rescue medicines for nausea, the diarrhoea plan and any growth-factor injections. Atropine may be used before irinotecan for the early reaction; mention glaucoma and asthma. Do not duplicate anti-sickness medicines, start supplements or take leftover prescriptions without checking with the oncology pharmacist.

Medicines and interactions

Bring all prescribed and non-prescribed medicines, supplements and anticoagulants to review. Tell the team before starting antibiotics or a new medicine. Do not independently stop regular treatment such as anticoagulants before a procedure.

Fertility, pregnancy and sex

Discuss fertility preservation before starting where relevant. Ask which contraception, pregnancy, breastfeeding and sex precautions apply during treatment and after the last dose. The period depends on your medicines and circumstances.

Practical support

Ask about work, driving, travel, nutrition, caring responsibilities and emotional support. Report symptoms in terms of what you can eat, drink or do. An interpreter, another explanation or a written plan can help you and a chosen family member or carer.

Your paper plan, wallet card and contacts

The three-page summary and handbook are usable without a phone.

Cycle and phase record

Ask the team to stamp or write the treatment actually given. For an open-ended course, use the passport for additional cycle records; blank spaces are not a prescribed number of treatments.

Before leaving

Confirm your next tests and appointments, pump disconnection when relevant, medicines to take at home and how to obtain urgent help. Explain the plan back in your own words; ask for anything unclear to be written down.

Questions worth asking

Does having more side effects mean treatment is working?

No. Side effects do not reliably show whether the cancer is responding. Report them so they can be treated. Your team assesses benefit using the tests and review plan appropriate to your cancer.

Why might a dose be delayed or reduced?

Your team may allow recovery, investigate a symptom or reduce the chance of lasting harm. Ask which drug changes, why, and when review is planned. A delay does not itself mean treatment has failed.

What should I say when calling?

Give the regimen name, last treatment date, symptoms and when they started. Explain whether you can eat, drink, pass urine and manage usual activities. Give your temperature if available, but do not delay calling to collect details.

What belongs in the consent conversation?

The individual aim and likely benefit, uncertainty, reasonable alternatives including not proceeding, common and serious risks, lasting effects, fertility and practical concerns. You can ask for an interpreter, more time or another explanation and can reconsider your decision.

How many cycles should I use this passport for?

The passport provides reusable recording pages, not a prescribed course length. Your oncology team sets the duration and can provide extra pages.

Will I need a port or a PICC?

The team chooses the most suitable access device with you. A port is under the skin; a PICC enters through the upper arm and has an external section. Both require specific care, and the pump can be used with either.

Does disconnecting the pump remove my port?

No. At the arranged visit the pump is disconnected and the line cared for. A port needle may be removed, but the implanted port stays under the skin until a separate removal procedure is arranged.

What if the pump finishes early or still looks full?

Contact the team for advice. Do not change delivery settings or disconnect or reconnect it yourself. Follow only the specific emergency steps you have been taught.

Is delayed diarrhoea the same as cramps during infusion?

No. Irinotecan can cause an early reaction with cramps, sweating or diarrhoea, and a later diarrhoea problem. Tell the nurse about early symptoms and follow the separate written plan at home.

Does the wallet QR contain my treatment record?

No. The printed QR opens this regimen's patient information. Your cycle stamps, appointments, test results and treatment changes remain in your own records and the clinical record.

Can I use the printed information without a phone?

Yes. The three-page summary, full handbook and passport can be printed. Ask your team to write the next appointments and working contact numbers on the paper copies.

> **Try explaining the plan back:** Can you explain which medicines you are receiving, the schedule, the contact plan and the symptoms that need prompt help?

Supportive prescription draft for review. This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

Aflibercept + FOLFIRI: active treatment cycle

Active medicines: Aflibercept + Irinotecan + Folinic acid + Fluorouracil

Emetogenic risk: Moderate

Medicine	Dose / route	When
Ondansetron	16 mg orally once	Before Day 1 chemotherapy Review QT risk, interactions, constipation and hepatic function.

Medicine	Dose / route	When
Dexamethasone	8 mg orally once	Before Day 1 chemotherapy Reconcile all steroid prescriptions; do not duplicate.
Dexamethasone	8 mg orally once daily	Days 2 and 3 after Day 1 chemotherapy Confirm the prescribed delayed prophylaxis and re-anchor it if treatment is delayed.
Metoclopramide	10 mg orally up to three times daily as required	Rescue only; duration to be completed by prescriber Review renal function, neurological contraindications and interactions.
Atropine sulphate	250 micrograms subcutaneously	Before irinotecan if prescribed Avoid in glaucoma. Acute cholinergic support is separate from delayed-diarrhoea treatment.

Additional phase-specific support

- Irinotecan has a moderate risk of sickness without prevention. Follow the prescribed prevention and rescue medicines. Call if vomiting prevents drinking; do not duplicate steroids or anti-sickness doses.
- Growth-factor injections depend on your risk, blood counts and previous complications. If prescribed, confirm their timing in relation to chemotherapy and pump removal; do not assume everyone receives them.
- Atropine is normally prescribed before irinotecan for early cramps, sweating or diarrhoea. It is avoided with glaucoma; tell the team about asthma as well. At home use the separately prescribed delayed-diarrhoea instructions. This can differ from standard over-the-counter dosing. Keep the medicine and urgent-contact plan available.
- NCCP delayed-diarrhoea rescue: loperamide 4 mg initially, then 2 mg every 2 hours until 12 hours after the last liquid stool; do not continue this high-dose schedule beyond 48 hours. Provide urgent escalation for fever, dehydration, pain or persistent diarrhoea. This is not the capecitabine-only rescue schedule.

Before signing: verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Mouth / swallowing

Fluorouracil + folinic acid

Report ulcers or pain that affects eating or drinking.

3 Bowel / stoma

Irinotecan / fluorouracil

Call early for diarrhoea, increased stoma output or poor intake; severe pain needs urgent assessment.

5 Blood / infection / bleeding

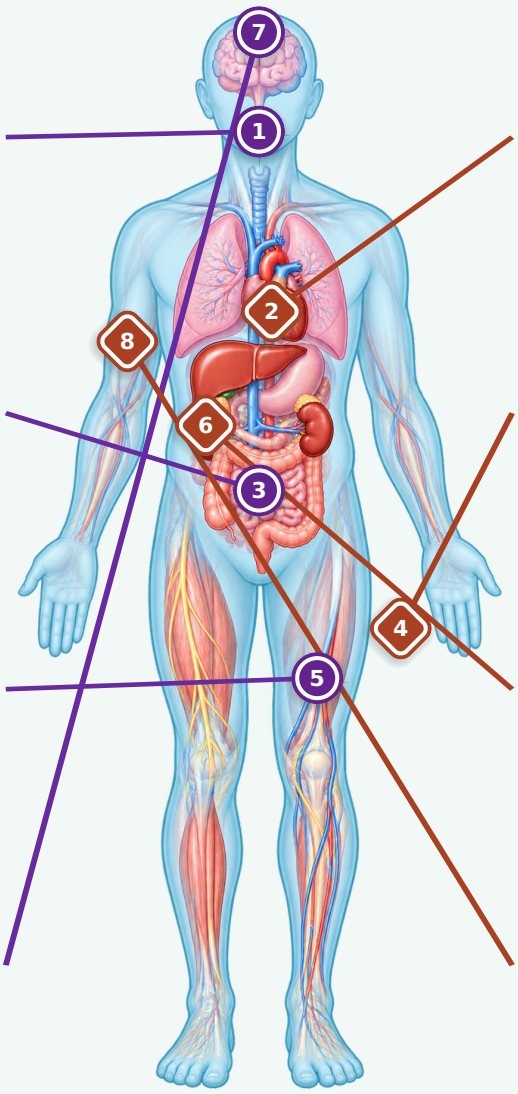
Chemotherapy / aflibercept

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: call now. Major bleeding or a swollen painful limb needs urgent review.

7 Head / blood pressure

Aflibercept

Severe headache, sudden weakness or visual change needs urgent assessment.



2 Chest

Fluorouracil

New chest pain, collapse or major breathing difficulty needs emergency help.

4 Hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Report painful redness, peeling or difficulty with everyday activities.

6 Kidneys / urine protein

Aflibercept

Keep urine and blood-pressure checks; report swelling or reduced urine.

8 Pump / line / healing

Treatment delivery / aflibercept

Call for leakage, swelling, line pain or a loose connection. Report poor wound healing and planned procedures.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or sudden illness needs immediate oncology advice. Chest pain, collapse or severe breathing difficulty needs emergency help. Call urgently for severe or persistent diarrhoea, severe abdominal pain, inability to drink, reduced urine or a line/pump problem. Major bleeding, a painful swollen limb, sudden weakness, a severe headache or visual change also needs urgent assessment.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

CHAPTER 04

Sources and further information

IN THIS CHAPTER

The references behind this information and addresses you can use to find further help.

Use this information alongside the plan agreed with your treatment team. Your team confirms your medicines, doses and appointments.

1. **National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00238 v6 · official regimen**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6336/238_v6_Aflibercept_and_FOLFIRI.pdf
2. **eviQ: implanted port**
   https://www.eviq.org.au/p/507
3. **eviQ: peripherally inserted central catheter (PICC)**
   https://www.eviq.org.au/p/543
4. **eviQ: infusion pump care**
   https://www.eviq.org.au/p/502
5. **HSE: chemotherapy side effects and urgent advice**
   https://www2.hse.ie/conditions/chemotherapy/side-effects/
6. **VELOUR: Van Cutsem et al. 2012**
   https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/22949147/
7. **EMA: Zaltrap product information**
   https://www.ema.europa.eu/en/documents/product-information/zaltrap-epar-product-information_en.pdf
8. **NCI: colon cancer treatment — carcinoembryonic antigen (CEA) and follow-up**
   https://www.cancer.gov/types/colorectal/hp/colon-treatment-pdq
9. **NCCP NCIS antiemetics V8, Table 1; apply oral regimen guidance separately**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/7180/Supportive_Care_Antiemetics_for_inclusion_NCIS_Medical_Oncology.pdf